

Document 6: Hostel Accommodation Rules & Mess Policy

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. Eligibility and Room Allocation Protocol

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT) provides on-campus residential facilities to foster a secure and academically focused environment. However, hostel accommodation is a privilege, not an absolute right, and capacity is strictly limited. The university maintains three primary residential blocks: Boys Hostel Block A (First-Year Students only), Boys Hostel Block B (Senior Students), and the centralized Girls Hostel Block (All Years).

To be eligible to apply for hostel accommodation, a student's permanent residential address—as verified by their Aadhar Card during admission—must be beyond a fifty-kilometer radius from the HIT campus. Local residents of Hyderabad and Secunderabad are strictly prohibited from occupying hostel seats to ensure that outstation students receive priority.

Room allocation is conducted purely on a merit-cum-distance basis. For first-year students, the TS EAMCET or JEE Main rank dictates the priority of allotment. For second, third, and fourth-year students, the previous year's CGPA is the sole determining factor. Any senior student with an active F-grade (backlog) or a history of disciplinary action in the hostel is automatically pushed to the bottom of the waiting list, regardless of their permanent address.

Room changes are not permitted during the ongoing academic year. Once a student is assigned a specific room and bed number, they must occupy it for the full two-semester duration. Mutual swapping of rooms between students without the written consent of the Chief Warden is treated as a security violation and attracts a spot fine of ₹2,500 for both involved parties.

2. Annual Fee Structure and Security Deposits

Hostel fees are separate from standard academic tuition and must be cleared in full before the student is allowed to physically move their belongings into the allotted room. The university does not offer installment plans for hostel accommodation.

The total financial obligation consists of three components: an annual Room Rent, a mandatory Annual Mess Charge, and a one-time Refundable Security Deposit. The Room Rent varies significantly depending on the occupancy type and whether the room is air-conditioned.

Table 2.1: Annual Room Rent Structure (Academic Year 2026-2027)

Room Category	Occupancy	Air-Conditioning	Annual Rent (₹)
Category 1	Single Sharing	AC	1,20,000
Category 2	Double Sharing	AC	95,000
Category 3	Double Sharing	Non-AC	70,000
Category 4	Triple Sharing	Non-AC	55,000

Note: First-year students are exclusively allotted Category 4 (Triple Seater, Non-AC) rooms to encourage peer interaction and adjust to campus life. Single seater rooms are strictly reserved for final-year students executing major graduation projects.

In addition to the room rent listed above, every resident must pay a fixed Annual Mess Charge of ₹65,000. This covers four meals a day for the standard ten-month

academic period. Furthermore, all new residents must deposit a one-time Refundable Security amount of ₹15,000. This deposit is held by the university until the student officially graduates or vacates the hostel permanently. Any damages to university furniture or unpaid library fines will be deducted from this deposit before the final refund is issued.

3. In-Time Curfew and Biometric Security

The safety of residential students is the highest priority for the HIT administration. To ensure strict monitoring, all hostel gates are equipped with biometric fingerprint scanners linked directly to the centralized campus security grid.

The campus enforces strict "In-Time" curfews that vary based on the student's academic seniority and gender, in compliance with state safety guidelines.

- **First-Year Boys (Block A):** Must cross the hostel boundary biometric gate by 9:00 PM on all weekdays and weekends.
- **Senior Boys (Block B):** Granted an extended curfew and must return to the hostel by 10:30 PM.
- **Girls Hostel (All Years):** Must return to the hostel premises by 8:30 PM. However, female students utilizing the central library or computer labs for academic work are permitted to stay out until 10:00 PM, provided they are escorted back to the hostel by the campus security patrol van.

If a student scans their fingerprint even one minute past their designated deadline, the system automatically flags them as a "Late Entry."

- **First Offense:** The student receives an automated warning email.
- **Second Offense:** The student's parents are automatically notified via SMS.
- **Third Offense:** The student is locked out of the electronic attendance system and must pay a late-entry penalty of ₹1,000 to the Warden's Office.
- **Fourth Offense:** The student faces immediate expulsion from the hostel for the remainder of the semester without any fee refund.

4. The Digital Gate Pass (Leave) System

Students are not held as prisoners; they are allowed to leave the campus to visit local markets, return to their hometowns, or attend family functions. However, they must officially notify the administration using the Digital Gate Pass system located on the HIT Student Portal. There are two distinct types of passes:

The Out-Pass (Local Day Leave):

An Out-Pass is used when a student wishes to leave the campus boundary during the day but intends to return before the night curfew.

- Students are entitled to a maximum of four Out-Passes per week.
- The pass must be generated on the mobile app at least one hour before leaving.
- The Out-Pass does not require parental permission or faculty approval. The security guard at the main campus gate simply scans the QR code on the student's phone to register their exit.

The Leave-Pass (Overnight / Hometown Leave):

A Leave-Pass is mandatory anytime a student plans to stay outside the hostel overnight, such as going home for the weekend or attending a hackathon in another city.

- The application must be submitted via the portal at least 24 hours in advance.
- Unlike the Out-Pass, the Leave-Pass requires a three-tier approval workflow. It must first be digitally approved by the student's Faculty Advisor, then by the Chief Warden, and finally authenticated via an OTP (One-Time Password) sent to the registered mobile number of the student's parents.
- If a student is found to have bypassed this system—for example, by sneaking off campus overnight or submitting a fake parental phone number—they will be instantly suspended from the hostel and reported to the institutional disciplinary committee.

5. Contraband and Electrical Appliance Policies

To prevent fire hazards, electrical grid overloads, and maintain a purely academic atmosphere, the university strictly dictates what items can and cannot be brought into the hostel rooms.

The campus electrical grid in the residential blocks is calibrated exclusively for low-draw devices. Students are legally permitted to operate laptops, mobile phone chargers, small desk lamps, and one personal grooming device (such as a hair dryer or electric shaver) under 1000 watts.

The possession or use of high-draw electrical heating appliances is categorized as a severe fire-safety violation. The following items are strictly banned: Electric kettles, induction stoves, rice cookers, electric irons, room heaters, and personal mini-refrigerators. The hostel maintenance staff conducts unannounced, randomized room inspections twice a month. If any banned electrical appliance is discovered, it is immediately confiscated and not returned until the end of the year. Additionally, a spot fine of ₹3,000 is levied against the room's occupants.

Furthermore, the possession of alcohol, narcotic substances, e-cigarettes, or tobacco products within the hostel premises is a zero-tolerance offense. Discovery of these items circumvents standard disciplinary warnings; it results in immediate police involvement, permanent expulsion from the university, and a permanent black mark on the student's academic transcript.

6. Centralized Mess and Dining Regulations

The HIT hostel mess operates on a large-scale catering model designed to provide hygienic, nutritionally balanced vegetarian and non-vegetarian meals. The dining halls strictly follow a fixed time schedule. If a student misses the serving window, the kitchen staff is under strict orders not to provide food, and the student must arrange for their own meal at the paid campus canteen.

Standard Mess Timings:

- **Breakfast:** 7:30 AM to 9:00 AM
- **Lunch:** 12:30 PM to 2:15 PM
- **Evening Snacks:** 5:00 PM to 6:00 PM
- **Dinner:** 7:45 PM to 9:30 PM

Food wastage is a critical issue monitored heavily by the administration. Students must only take what they can consume. A "Waste Audit Board" is placed near the plate disposal area. If a student is caught repeatedly leaving large quantities of uneaten food on their tray, the Mess Manager is authorized to impose a "Food Wastage Fine" of ₹500 directly to their student account.

Taking mess utensils (stainless steel plates, spoons, or glasses) or raw food items outside the dining hall into the hostel rooms is strictly prohibited. The only exception is the "Sick Diet" protocol. If a student is suffering from a high fever or severe illness, their roommate can submit a slip signed by the Campus Medical Officer to the kitchen staff. The kitchen will then provide a customized, easily digestible meal (such as khichdi or plain porridge) packed in disposable containers to be taken to the sick student's room.

7. Summer Vacation and Room Vacating Protocols

The hostel contract is valid only for the standard ten-month academic session (August to May). The hostels are officially closed during the months of June and July for deep cleaning, pest control, and infrastructure maintenance.

Within 48 hours of completing their final Semester End Examination, every student must completely vacate their room. The university does not provide on-campus storage for personal belongings over the summer. Students must pack all clothes, books, and electronics and take them home. Leaving items behind in locked cupboards is prohibited; any padlocks left on cupboards after the deadline will be broken by the maintenance staff, and the contents will be donated to local charities.

The only students permitted to reside in the hostel during the summer vacation are those officially registered for the Fast-Track Summer Term to clear backlogs, or students undertaking an official, mandatory summer research project under an HIT faculty member. These authorized summer residents will be consolidated into a single wing of Block B to conserve electricity and security resources, and they must pay a separate Summer Mess Fee of ₹6,500 per month.